

NIKOLAI KOCEV

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER & PILOT

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PROFILE

Former flight instructor turned developer, blending precision and discipline from aviation with a passion for technology. When the skies quieted during the pandemic, I discovered the world of Linux, open source, and software development. I thrive on learning, problem-solving, and building reliable systems. Outside of tech, I recharge through music, yoga, writing poetry and short stories, and wide-ranging reading.

HARD SKILLS

- **OS:** GNU/Linux | macOS | Windows
- **Programming languages:**
JavaScript | Go
- **Databases:** SQL | MongoDB
- **Version Control:** Git
- **Containers & orchestration:**
Docker | Kubernetes
- **Networking concepts:** OSI model |
TCP/IP | UDP/IP | DNS | Firewalls
- **Cloud:** Google Cloud Platform

SOFT SKILLS

- Analytical and solution-oriented
- Structured and detail-oriented
- Fast learner with strong technical curiosity
- Self-driven and collaborative
- Strong sense of responsibility and focus on delivery
- Strong ability to grasp complex systems quickly
- Clear and professional communicator
- Calm and dependable under pressure

EXPERIENCE

FREELANCE DEVELOPER

Current technical focus: React / JavaScript, Go, Docker & Kubernetes

Oct 2024 - Present

- While seeking full-time employment, I actively build real-world projects in React and Go, containerize applications with Docker, and deepen my understanding of Kubernetes and cloud-native workflows.
- In parallel, I am expanding my practical IT support offering for individuals and small businesses, with a focus on Linux installation, Windows-to-Linux migration, system setup, troubleshooting, backups, and general technical assistance.
- I also explore AI concepts and cloud-native development to stay current with modern software engineering practices.
- Part-time substitute teacher at Östratörnskolan, Lund.
- Aviation: renewed SEP (Land) and Instrument Rating, while keeping my frozen ATPL theory current.

BACKEND DEVELOPER - IKEA - CDA

JS & GCP (Google Cloud Platform)

June 2024 - Sep 2024

Co-developed an Availability Test API to simulate customer clicks and purchases, validating the team's data pipeline and improving understanding of system behavior. Strengthened my ability to work within large codebases and deepened my understanding of complex data flows by carefully studying and documenting system behavior.

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Fluent
- **Swedish:** Fluent
- **Bulgarian:** Fluent
- **Dutch:** Beginner

EDUCATION

HIGHER VOCATIONAL EDUCATION

Teknikhögskolan - Full-Stack Developer, Specialization in JavaScript
Lund, Sweden.
Aug 2021 - June 2023

HIGHER VOCATIONAL EDUCATION

South Sweden School of Aeronautics, SPU Flight Academy:
CPL | ATPL | FI(A) | ME/IR | 550 hrs
2010 - 2014

SWEDISH ARMED FORCES

Amphibious Regiment (Amf 1), Mortar Platoon.
2009 - 2010

HIGH SCHOOL - SPYKEN

Natural Science Programme, Lund.
2004 - 2007

BACKEND DEVELOPER - IKEA - INTERACTION CORE

JS, Python (Locust), Redis & Bigtable, Bash, Docker, GCP
Feb 2023 - Aug 2023

During my second internship, my classmate and I conducted a thesis project comparing Redis and Bigtable to strengthen our team's understanding of modern data storage solutions. After completing the thesis, I continued as a summer developer at IKEA, working with two colleagues to design and implement a Bigtable API.

FRONTEND DEVELOPER - ONE NORDIC AB

C#, JS & Bootstrap
Apr 2022 - Jun 2022

During my first internship, I focused on enhancing the UX/UI design of the company's new website, improving responsiveness with Bootstrap, and integrating the Google Maps API. Following the internship, I was employed for an extra month as a summer worker, further contributing to web development and design tasks.

AIRPORT ANALYST - FLYGPRESTANDA AB

GNU/Linux & Bash
Jan 2021 - Aug 2021

Updated an in-house database with new information (new runways, obstacles, etc.). Created engine-out procedures on request from customers.

FREELANCE FIRST OFFICER - ROYAL AIR, BROMMA

C525
Oct 2019 - July 2020

Flew for a small private jet company (Cessna Citation CJ3). I was located in Stockholm.

KRISTIANSTAD & ESLÖV FLYGKLUBB - FI (PPL)

PA28, C152
Jan 2018 - Aug 2021

Flight instructor, taught students to fly small airplanes in Kristianstad and Eslöv, in Skåne County. Also flew tour flights for people who wanted to try flying.

SIMULATOR PILOT - ENTRY POINT NORTH, MALMÖ

Jan 2017 - Dec 2020

At EPN, I operated a specialized software simulation for ATC student training, executing aircraft control commands issued by the trainees. This role involved managing virtual aircraft within the simulated environment, providing a realistic and safe training experience to develop their air traffic control skills.